

Outlook

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Follow-up: why did the payment fail, and who owns the fix?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Operations is grouping all failed payments together even though the next action depends on the actual cause. Failure anecdotes are beginning to drive decisions, although retries and late posting may be making the problem look larger than the affected-customer population.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if third-party or bank timeout explains the event?
2. What evidence would instead support that insufficient funds explains the event?
3. How do we rule out that mandate status or retry sequencing explains the event?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use March 2021 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards the operational owner, customer message and monitoring rule for each failure family. A useful output would be a working Excel file with the exception population and clear columns.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Do not infer a technical component failure beyond the error and timing fields available.

Regards